



Building a Digital Diary Application in App Inventor 2

In this popular series on creating mobile apps using App Inventor 2, the author presents yet another useful app which can be used to stimulate our creative instincts. Join the author in building a digital diary.

Smartphones have completely changed the way we perform many everyday tasks. Now we don't cross dates on our paper calendars to remember upcoming events because our phone is smart enough to give us a reminder of the date and time. Similarly, we rarely use paper and pen to note down the small details we want to remember, especially when we are away from home or office. Things can be written on the phone to be checked later. Google Play Store is flooded with so many note-taking apps and each one of them is more advanced than the other.

In this article, we will develop our own digital diary app in App Inventor 2. Using the app, we will be able to note down things instantly to be viewed later, any time and anywhere.

As in all previous issues, let's first discuss the specifications required for the application, the actual requirements and then go on to put things in place. So we will first consider the GUI requirements and the appearance of the app. Once we are clear about the look and feel we want, we will add behaviour to the components.

GUI requirements

We are hoping to give users a chance to create new notes and to view any previously saved notes. For that, we will need to have two independent buttons.

We will require the components given in the table below for this project.

	Component's name	Purpose	Location
1	Horizontal arrangement	To arrange the child components horizontally	Palette-->Layout-->Horizontal Arrangement
2	Label	To display text	Palette-->User Interface-->Label
3	Button	To trigger an event	Palette-->User Interface-->Button
4	Button	To trigger some action	Palette-->User Interface-->Button
5	TinyDB	To store the data persistently	Palette-->Storage-->TinyDB
6	Clock	To get the system time	Palette-->Sensors-->Clock

1. Drag and drop the components mentioned in the table above to the viewer.
2. Visible components can be seen by you while the non-visible components will be located beneath the viewer under the tag *Non-visible*.
3. We have placed a label so as to display the name of the application.
4. All buttons need to be placed within the horizontal arrangement in order to keep them aligned horizontally.
5. If you have dragged and placed everything, the layout will look something like what's shown in Figure 1.